ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** K. A. Abbas	Khwaja Ahmad Abbas wrote it.
2	**(b)** worried about her future	She worried about the unmarried daughter.
3	**(d)** marked with scars	Smallpox scars.
4	**(c)** Sulekha	Her proper name was Sulekha.
5	**(a)** with kindness and patience	She encouraged her.
6	**(a)** stutter	Stutter.
7	**(b)** simpleton	'Bholi' suggests a simple, slow girl.
8	**(d)** it gave her confidence and speech	She changed.
9	**(c)** bold	Bold.
10	**(d)** Ramlal, the village revenue official	Ramlal worked as Numberdar.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Bholi's real name was Sulekha (1) and she was nicknamed Bholi, simpleton, because she seemed slow and stammered (1).	1+1
12	She treated her kindly and with patience (1) and gave her confidence to read and speak (1).	1+1
13	She said she would stay with him (1) and care for her parents, perhaps as a teacher (1).	1+1
14	She fell from a cot as a baby and was injured (1) and had smallpox at two which left her face pockmarked (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Bholi was the youngest of Ramlal's children. A fall as a baby hurt her and smallpox scarred her face. She stammered and was thought a simpleton. She was neglected by her family.	1+1+1
16	It shows that she has grown into a brave, self-respecting woman. She does not accept insult or greed. Education gave her the courage.	1+1+1
17	Bholi was timid but she became bold after school. Both verbs in simple past.	1+1+1
	OR: The Tehsildar came to the village and urged Ramlal to send girls to school. As a revenue officer, Ramlal had to set an example. So the school started and Bholi was sent.	1+1+1
18	Dowry is shown as greedy bargaining over a bride. The father is humiliated and the girl treated as a burden. Bholi's refusal rejects this practice.	1+1+1
	OR: The dowry system is wrong. Bholi used to stammer. Education gave her confidence.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Sulekha, youngest child, nicknamed Bholi (1). Scarred by smallpox, stammers (1). Educated by a kind teacher (1). Gains confidence (1). Refuses a greedy groom and chooses to serve her parents (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). The dowry demand (1). Her decision (1). Feelings (1). Plans for the future (1).	2+2+1
20	She was timid before school (1). The teacher's kindness (1). She learned to read and speak (1). She gained self-respect (1). She took a brave decision (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Father's shame (1). Bholi's calm words (1). Offer to care for him (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Bholi an educated girl at the start; she is a **shy, slow girl who stammers**, pock-marked from smallpox, whose real name is **Sulekha**.
- Saying her parents sent her to school gladly; they did so because she was unlikely to be married and school was a *last resort*.
- Giving the wrong reason for refusal: she rejected the groom **Bishamber** because he demanded dowry and was lame, not out of anger.
- Forgetting the teacher: her **kindness** gave Bholi confidence and led to her transformation.

- Mixing the end: Bholi chooses to remain unmarried, **stay and teach** in the village school, and look after her parents.
- Spelling slips: *Bholi, Sulekha, Bishamber, dowry, stammer, Ramlal*.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Bishamber	Bishamber.
2	**(d)** fool	Simpleton.
3	**(d)** youngest	She was the youngest.
4	**(a)** the groom demanded dowry and showed greed	She would not marry a greedy man.
5	**(d)** sympathetic and hopeful	Sympathy and hope.
6	**(b)** she fell from a cot and was hurt	The accident affected her growth.
7	**(c)** stay with her parents and serve them, perhaps as a teacher	She chose independence and duty.
8	**(c)** confident and self-respecting	She stands up.
9	**(d)** smallpox	Smallpox left her face pockmarked.
10	**(c)** the growth of a girl's self-respect through education	Education empowers.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	She learned to read and write (1) and became confident and lost her fear (1).	1+1
12	It empowers girls (1) and gives them self-respect and the courage to choose (1).	1+1
13	Her face was scarred and she stammered (1) and she was thought to be slow-witted (1).	1+1
14	They asked for a large dowry (1) which showed their greed (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	She was frightened and stammered so badly that other children laughed. The teacher spoke gently and encouraged her. Slowly Bholi felt safe and began to learn.	1+1+1
16	At first she was timid, stammering and ignored. At the end she is confident and speaks clearly. She decides her future boldly.	1+1+1
17	Bholi was judged by her scarred face. Her inner strength proved greater. Real worth lies in character.	1+1+1
	OR: The teacher was the first person to treat Bholi with respect. Her kindness gave Bholi courage. She taught her to read and to believe in herself.	1+1+1
18	Ramlal and his wife see daughters as a burden and fear for their marriages. Bholi proves a daughter can be a support. The story encourages a change in attitude.	1+1+1
	OR: The name shows how society labels people. It sums up the world's low opinion of her. The story then proves the label wrong.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Birth, accident, smallpox (1). The Tehsildar's visit (1). School and the teacher (1). The marriage and dowry demand (1). Bholi's refusal (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Respect daughters (1). Educate girls (1). Reject dowry (1). Do not judge by looks (1). Encourage courage (1).	2+2+1
20	Bishamber demands dowry (1). Father is humiliated (1). Marriage becomes bargaining (1). Bholi rejects it (1). The message is clear (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Early: neglected, stammering (1). Later: confident, speaking clearly (1). Cause: school (1). Result: self-respect (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Bholi an educated girl at the start; she is a **shy, slow girl who stammers**, pock-marked from smallpox, whose real name is **Sulekha**.
- Saying her parents sent her to school gladly; they did so because she was unlikely to be married and school was a *last resort*.
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- Forgetting the teacher: her **kindness** gave Bholi confidence and led to her transformation.
- Mixing the end: Bholi chooses to remain unmarried, **stay and teach** in the village school, and look after her parents.
- Spelling slips: *Bholi, Sulekha, Bishamber, dowry, stammer, Ramlal*.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 17: **Bholi (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Bholi said that she would not marry him.	Backshift.
2	**(d)** speaking, she stammered	She stammered.
3	**(d)** the evil of dowry	Dowry is criticised.
4	**(b)** girls	Girls' school.
5	**(d)** the Tehsildar	The Tehsildar urged him.
6	**(c)** money or goods given by a bride's family at marriage	Dowry.
7	**(b)** change a person's life	Education empowers.
8	**(c)** she was seen as not likely to marry so schooling was an option	Others had better prospects of marriage.
9	**(b)** The groom was refused by Bholi.	Past passive.
10	**(b)** income from taxes	Government income.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	The dowry system (1) which treats girls as a burden and bargains over marriage (1).	1+1
12	The Tehsildar asked Ramlal to set an example by sending his daughters (1) and as Bholi was unlikely to marry, she was the one sent (1).	1+1
13	He had shown greed and demanded dowry (1) and she would not marry a man who valued money over her (1).	1+1
14	At first she stammers badly (1) but at the end she speaks firmly and clearly (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He was worried about Bholi's marriage because of her looks. Bishamber's family seemed willing at first. He accepted for the sake of security.	1+1+1
16	Ramlal is a village official, anxious and conventional. His wife worries about the child's future. Neither understands her ability till the end.	1+1+1
17	Bholi stands up for herself. She chooses duty and independence over a greedy marriage. The ending is inspiring and complete.	1+1+1
	OR: The wedding was held with a crowd. The groom's side demanded dowry. Bholi, who had become confident, stood up and refused to marry. The guests were amazed.	1+1+1
18	Bholi told her father that she would look after him. 'Said to' becomes 'told' and 'will' becomes 'would'.	1+1+1
	OR: She learned to speak to them with confidence. At the end she supports her father in his shame. Education made her a source of strength.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	A kind woman (1). Patient with Bholi (1). Taught her to speak (1). Treated her with respect (1). A turning point in her life (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Opening (1). Bholi's example (1). Benefits (1). Social change (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Wedding assembly (1). Groom asks for dowry (1). Bholi stands up and speaks (1). Refuses firmly (1). People are amazed (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Address and date (1). Salutation (1). Summary (1). What you liked (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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